

Support Doubles

Support Doubles and Redoubles

Used by opener to show 3-card support for responder's major when opponents interfere.

Support Double

When it applies: Opener has opened, responder bid a major, and an opponent overcalls (through 2♠).

Auction example: 1♣ - (P) - 1♥ - (1♠) - **Dbl** = opener has exactly 3 hearts

Opener's action	Meaning
Double	Exactly 3-card support for responder's major
Raise to 2M	4-card support

Why it matters: Responder now knows whether to expect 3- or 4-card support when bidding game or slam, which affects how they evaluate their hand.

After the support double, responder knows opener has exactly 3-card support.
Responder's options:

Responder action	Meaning
2 of own major	Minimum hand; does NOT promise 5 cards — may be only 4
3 of own major	Invitational (typically 8-10 pts with 5+ cards)
2NT	Invitational (8-10 pts, no major interest)
3NT / 4M	Game-forcing, places contract
New suit	Natural and forcing (game interest)
Pass	Convert to penalty double; Happy to defend against their overcall

Key principle: Rebidding the major at the 2-level after a support double is a minimum, non-forcing action. It does **not** promise 5 cards in the major — opener has shown 3, and together you know you have a 7-card fit (possibly 8 if responder holds 5). Responder passes or raises based on combined values, not assumed trump count.

With 3-card support from opener: - 7-card fit (4+3) is playable but not ideal — prefer NT at higher point counts if the hand is balanced. - 8-card fit (5+3) plays normally — bid the major.

Support Redouble

When it applies: Same situation as the support double, but the opponent **doubles** instead of overcalling.

Auction example: 1♣ - (P) - 1♥ - (Dbl) - **Rdbl** = opener has 3-card support for hearts

Opener's action	Meaning
Redouble	3-card support for responder's major
Raise to 2M	4-card support

Applies through: 2♠ (same as support double)